

August 12, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Violet Gerhold (MRN MUSC5753947), Claim MUSC-20260415-9D0C-1

Patient	Violet Gerhold (DOB 2017-02-25)
MRN	MUSC5753947
Member ID / Group	BCB657213008 / GRP-77365
Claim number	MUSC-20260415-9D0C-1
Date of service	2026-04-15
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$526.77
Denial code	CARC 204 / RARC N130 — This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-31

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health respectfully submits this first-level provider reconsideration on behalf of patient Violet Gerhold (MRN: MUSC5753947, Member ID: BCB657213008, Group: GRP-77365) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260415-9D0C-1 for services rendered on April 15, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was submitted on April 30, 2026, and denied on June 2, 2026, under CARC 204 ("This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." MUSC Health contests this determination and requests full reconsideration and payment of the billed amount of \$526.77.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Violet Gerhold is a nine-year-old established female patient who presented on April 15, 2026, for an outpatient evaluation at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower, Place of Service 22. The visit was rendered by James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465) and billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, under primary diagnosis J06.9, Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified. The patient's coverage under the BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus plan is active and continuous from January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, encompassing the date of service in question.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial characterizes CPT 99214 as a non-covered service under the member's benefit plan. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this conclusion. CPT 99214 is a standard evaluation and management service that is broadly recognized as a covered benefit under commercial health plans, including outpatient established-patient visits for acute illness. Acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9) is a common, clinically recognized condition requiring physician evaluation, and the level of service billed reflects the medical complexity appropriate to the encounter as documented by the rendering provider.

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina has not identified a specific exclusion within the member's benefit document that would apply to this category of service. A routine outpatient evaluation and management visit for an acute illness does not fall within the types of services that are customarily excluded from commercial plan benefits, such as cosmetic procedures, experimental treatments, or services rendered outside the plan's network parameters. The patient's plan was active on the date of service, the rendering provider performed a covered type of service at a recognized outpatient facility, and the diagnosis is a legitimate acute medical condition. In the absence of a clearly articulated and applicable exclusion, denial under CARC 204 is not supported.

MUSC Health further notes that the payer's own remittance reflects an allowed amount of \$379.51, which indicates the plan's fee schedule recognizes this service as payable. The assignment of a non-zero allowed amount is inconsistent with a determination that the service is categorically non-covered. This discrepancy warrants immediate review and correction.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-20260415-9D0C-1, identify and provide the specific benefit exclusion language relied upon in issuing the denial, and reprocess the claim for payment. If the payer's position is that a lesser amount is payable, MUSC Health requests payment of at least the allowed amount of \$379.51 consistent with the contracted fee schedule, with a written explanation of any remaining adjustment. This reconsideration is submitted within the appeal deadline of August 31, 2026, via My Insurance Manager, with the remittance advice and supporting medical records attached.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record